

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 2

ALABAMA
WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — a cross-location dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Alabama's family courts and child-welfare system.

158

ALABAMA FAMILIES ON RECORD · 321 CHILDREN IMPACTED · 13 MONTHS MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING TIME

DATA AS OF
NOVEMBER 7, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
47 OF 67

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS · ALABAMA

A name appears below only after 3 or more independent families have named the same actor in Alabama. Submitter names, emails, and contact details are never published. Comments below are direct family reports — one per family — with all identifying information removed.

William E. Scully, Jr.

JUDGE · BALDWIN · **16 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"The custody case remained stayed for an extended period while related criminal proceedings were pending. During a related hearing, evidence was presented but the court indicated the issues should be addressed through family court proceedings."*

> *"He wouldn't except none of my drug test i paid for and it was like he had his mind up already he didn't care to listen to what i had and everyone was so against me and I have never abused my kids or anything it didn't make sense"*

> *"Another judge that doesn't want listen to evidence just wants to listen to what DHR says no matter that they don't have proof. All just "feelings" and what they think a person might do."*

> *"I had to get on the ladder and he will take her side punish me get onto me without listening to any facts and and believe her lies in her attorneys, fabricated instances"*

> *"Violated my civil rights and never considered the best interest of my daughter Dismissed case without following proper procedures and violated my civil rights"*

> *"Repeatedly ignored evidence, engages in ex parte comms, ignores domestic violence, blames victims, denies notice and due process"*

> *"Dismissed a long-standing protective order without reviewing documentary evidence I had submitted or requested to present."*

> *"Didn't care to hear me plead my case believed everything he was told knowing it was lies n defamation of character"*

> *"Did not listen to my testimony. Lied and said my daughter had left rehab. She was still there."*

> *"He took away my children with no evidence hearing Has never been given an evidentiary hearing."*

> *"Deleting documents from the record. Will not allow me to speak. Sides with dhr"*

> *"ONLY LISTENING TO DHR NOT LETTIN ME SPEAK NOR WAS DHR LETTIN ME TALK"*

> *"Drags out court cases also believes false reports"*

> *"He keeps children away without hearings."*

> *"They didnt even let me testify"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/al-william-e-scully-jr/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Joy Booth

JUDGE · AUTAUGA · **7 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Refused Forensic Interview, Hospital Reports, Police Reports, & Therapy Reports into evidence. No due process. Ex-husband tested positive in court for Methamphetamine & Amphetamines, has 7 current warrents, and was on probation. He got full custody. All my rights have been taken. She refused forensic interview, hospital reports, therapy and psychiatric reports on children into evidence. The opposing party tested positive for Amphetamines & Methamphetamine. Oppsing party was on probation with 6 warrents and got given full custody."*

> *"Denied rights. Jailed me for not paying Gal. My ex husband still hasn't paid Gal. Judged me to pay my ex husband's attorney fees. Took my children with no explanation Took my visitation with no hearing. Forced vaccines on my children. Allowed my attorney to quit after 2 years, a month before trial. Denied my right to fair trial. Denied motion to continue for time to get attorney. Etc!"*

> *"Evidence was presented that showed that my child's father was threatening to harm both me and my child. She said "this was in the past and is irrelevant." My child was approximately 9 months old at the time and the threats were made after he was born."*

> *"Failed to uphold requirements of a safety plan. Declined to accept testimony on Mother's behalf. Discussed details of the case to people that were outside of the case and made her judgement without ever seeing the mother."*

> *"Completely ignored the constitution, deprived me and my daughter of our rights, no due process. Friends with my ex and his new wife. She's a horrible judge."*

> *"Ignored evidence, denied my rights and blocked my attempts to get in front of her with the evidence in question"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/al-joy-booth/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Kyle Shirley

ATTORNEY · AUTAUGA COUNTY · **6 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"He has repeatedly helped a rapist and kidnapper get custody. He persisted in pushing charges on me for interference with custody when I tried to get my children to the hospital covered in bruises & welts. My children cried out that their dad beat them with belts. Attorney to my ex-husband who has continuously defended a documented abuser and has repeatedly reported false accusations. Opposing party attorney helping to mask the abuse."*

> *"He hid evidence, we subpoenaed her medical records. He said he never received so I went to the medical office, pretending to be from his office. They confirmed they had sent them and provided me with another copy. He colluded with the other side against me opposing attorney is it was his best friend in high school. They are all in it together."*

> *"GAL didn't interview, talk or visit with me concerning my parenting and relationship with my child. Not a phone call or meeting with me. He played a huge role in the decision in court and the court of civil appeals."*

> *"Represented the other party. Had undisclosed personal and familial ties to his client. Conflict of interest."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/al-kyle-shirley/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Carol Cook Carter

JUDGE · AUTAUGA · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Saw the evidence presented where my child's father was threatening to harm both me and my child. She still advocated for the father and he ultimately received joint custody. I fully believe this is because she was, and is, very close friends with the father's attorney."*

> *"Told me she would get her money one way or the other. Had me jailed with no way out but to pay. Ex husband still hasn't paid her."*

> *"Served as counsel for father at one point, offered to represent me at another."*

> *"Been blocked from reviewing her website"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/al-carol-cook-carter/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Thea Barnes Langley

THERAPIST / COUNSELOR · AUTAUGA · **5 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Judge ordered two visits with children. Another therapist who worked with children for 1.5 years called Thea to report the abuse, including fractured skull x 2, participle hearing loss, Black eyes, bruises & welts, the children disclosed with their father as the perpetrator. Other therapist & hospital informed Thea that ongoing contact with father would exasperated children symptoms. Thea did not include any of the information in her report that was disclosed by other therapist or hospital. Infact, Thea reported children were happy, healthy and well dressed and never disclosed any of the other therapist or hospital reports or findings in her report. Children have since been given to their father."*

> *"Very manipulative with children, highly unqualified for the position, extremely unprofessional, unethical and causes extreme damage to an already delicate situation. She cares nothing about a parent and child relationship and promotes separation."*

> *"Helped cover up evidence, ignored my evidence, was knowledgeable and covered up for the misconduct of the GAL and the attorney."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/al-thea-barnes-langley/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Abbey Johnston

ATTORNEY · BALDWIN · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Abbey did not want to listen to me even with me having proof. She continued to support my ex-husband even when I showed her evidence of him alienating the kids from me. Once I paid her fees she just stopped talking to me. I reached out to her multiple times about my kids welfare and she never responded. She now will not meet with me or communicate with me at all. She allows kids to suffer and does not have their best interest at all. Works hand in hand with DHR and does not listen to things right in front of her."*

> *"Simultaneously argues against reunification of a sober parent while representing the grandparent seeking to adopt who self admits he's a "functioning alcoholic"."* BALDWIN COUNTY AL

> *"She gave a false report on me without evidence."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/al-abbey-johnston/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Andrew Hairston CONTINUED 1 / 3

JUDGE · CHEROKEE COUNTY · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Refused to hear the abuse to me and my siblings . Sent my baby brother with an abusive step father w/out seeing evidence exparte . Refused to hear emergency hearing protection orders and lied on orders that he heard all witnesses and both parties when transcripts prove only one side was heard . Threatened me and my siblings and my mother . Violated Alabama laws federal laws and civil and constitutional rights . Refuses to hear, domestic violence protection orders Refuses to allow emergency hearings when children are in danger Rules export in sciences, export orders for Chad Hopper, and as favors for attorneys in the back room Violate constitutional rights, Alabama constitution and United States constitution He is biased and does not protect children He is in the masons and rules for as favors for Masons that are in the secret society with him He does not uphold Alabama law, federal laws, or domestic violence protection laws He signs illegal orders above his authority to prevent domestic violence, parents from being able to move even it's if it's in the Alabama guidelines for parents to be able to move within 77 miles he still signs formed to prevent them from moving He does not protect children and follow the Alabama laws or federal laws as far as protecting children or the best interest of the child He has one-sided hearings and only hears one side of the hearing and then makes a ruling He has threatened women that if they present their domestic violence cases, or if they present their modification hearings or if they present their cases of child abuse against their abuser that he will arrest them and hold them in contempt and take their children from them He is not concerned with the safety of children or abuse of children He has signed numerous ex parte orders for"*

CONTINUES ON THE NEXT CARD

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Andrew Hairston CONTINUED 2 / 3

JUDGE · CHEROKEE COUNTY · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

FAMILY COMMENT CONTINUED

"attorneys behind closed door and then he has signed order stating that he heard the full case and heard all evidence when the transcripts do not match that He has prolonged hearings that last three for six years while children are having to visit abusive parents He also refuses to hear that a father was absent for 4 1/2 years and it's not the biological father in order ex parte orders that one of four children has to go with a parent that he does not know that is not biological without a hearing And he also separates siblings. There is numerous cases where he has deliberately separated, siblings permanently, and also in my case, he separates siblings every holiday. He does not enforce that of father supports all children. He lets the father's chief which children the father likes and wants to see, and he also supports fathers neglecting and abusing three or four children."

"He signed exparte orders and denied me the route. I have my protection orders heard he also failed to look at evidence or hear witnesses or to protect children which by law he is supposed to and he is allowing my children not to be abused installed continuously by my ex, he is not upholding the law and he's violating constitutional rights. He is also a Mason with my ex-husband and he is not making decisions by the laws and is not upholding the law. The judge made threats to me, and he never allowed me to present my cases. None of my cases have been heard. My modification has not been heard my protection orders have not been heard and abuse has been reported to him and neglect to my son and he refuses to hear it. he does not want to hear it at all."

"Denied my request for continuance due to not having representation or preparation to represent myself, made a final ruling stripping my rights based off of false accusations and beliefs with absolutely no evidence and dismissed my initial hearing for temporary custody even after supporting evidence was presented to the court. The judge made a final ruling without supporting evidence and dismissed the initial case even with supporting evidence provided." DEKALB COUNTY

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Andrew Hairston CONTINUED 3 / 3

JUDGE · CHEROKEE COUNTY · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"He heard abuse to children and to ex spouse and ignored . Ruled basis one sided and denied the abused protection and ignored all abuse evidence"* CIRCUIT COURT CHEROKEE COUNTY

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/al-andrew-hairston/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Sibley G. Reynolds

JUDGE · CHILTON · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Changed hearing date several times. The children wanted to testify on their own behalf. Grandfather did not want this to happen. Changed hearing to a date mother would not have them. He then allowed the GAL to say that the children spoke with him and he could confidently say they were safe and happy with Grandfather. Refused to look at messages I had from the children disproving this statement. The judge knew my case was heavily dependent on audio and video since he would not allow the children to testify in person. Moved our hearing to a room that had no audio visual capabilities. Allowed my father to submit the childrens report cards as evidence of their "well-being" and dismissed the entire case."* AUTUAGA

> *"I moved 23 miles away from the marital house. My ex objected. The judge agreed and stopped the mood. Finally got approved to move but my children had to continue going to the previous school system for a year and a half. I had to drive 35 to 45 minutes twice a day to take my kids to and from school for a whole school year and a half of another. He dismissed everything. Evidence, subpoenas, contempt charges, everything."*

> *"Was a cousin by marriage to the other party"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/al-sibley-g-reynolds/complaint-packet
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Ali Upchurch Patterson

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · CHILTON · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"She has talked down to us told on we will never get our children back i have voice recording of her telling me your a grown ass woman who cares about your feelings. She also stated " I don't see how the judge is not going to tpr yall"*

> *"Failed to follow rules of court, put herself on record prior to representing opposition, violated state law in motions filed."*

> *"Did not investigate the mother at all in either case"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/al-ali-upchurch-patterson/complaint-packet
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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Carmen Bosch

JUDGE · BALDWIN · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Gave joint custody to a man who was not the father or had ever been married to my daughter. He was arrested for selling drugs.... He was violent with my daughter in front of child. Police were called. This Judge awarded SIL custody at a bogus default hearing. The ruling was finally set aside but granddaughter remain with SIL until trial which was two years later."*

> *"Did not even review the psychologist's medical report that cleared me of the false allegations of mental illness. The judge told the attorneys in chambers that she intended to side with DHR before giving full consideration to the evidence. I was denied due process thus allowing the medical kidnapping of my newborn grandson at North Baldwin Infirmary Hospital."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/al-carmen-bosch/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

DeAnne "Dee Dee" Calhoon

JUDGE · ELMORE COUNTY · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Proceeds where jurisdiction does not allow. Failure to follow rules of court, ignores state statues, failure to acknowledge jurisdiction. Motion filed, Judge Calhoun allowed Father 7 days to respond, his response did not acknowledge statue or jurisdiction limits, Judge Calhoun then ignored all and left motions hanging. Subjected children to re visit trauma in therapy in spite of previously completing therapy, therapist recommended no contact, GAL recommended no contact. Father has been convicted of sex crimes with children the named victims and contact supervised or not would violate state statue. Judge does not Have jurisdiction to rule or consider ruling in violation of state law, doing so would be a violation of due process and equal protection under the law ."* CHILTON

> *"Cold and creul to the mother. Imediately made an assumption and would never admit that maybe she was wrong.Mother provided proof of abuse by the grandfather, she ignored."*

> *"She ignored obvious crucial evidence and testimony and denied a plea for family counseling"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/al-deanne-dee-dee-calhoon/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Natalie Jones

ATTORNEY / GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · BALDWIN COUNTY · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"I believe the litigation strategy prioritized continued conflict over timely resolution. The prolonged proceedings consumed resources that could have been used to support my daughter's care, treatment, housing, and stability. My daughter has special needs and depends on consistent services and routine. The ongoing litigation contributed to disruption, instability, and hardship during a critical period of her development. Repeatedly litigated custody issues while domestic violence issues remained unresolved. Positions taken during the case contributed to prolonged proceedings, escalating legal expenses exceeding $100,000, and significant delays in achieving stability for my child. Used delay tactics, and imposed costly mediations and proposals."*

> *"Refuses to listen to my children regardless of video evidence. Refuses to meet with child often, calls my child manipulative, dismisses video after video of mental and emotional abuse my child sends her, has had relations with parties in my case yet refuses to recuse herself, tells me I can't attend public events, allows my child to be switched over and over for medical providers"*

> *"My child has sent numerous videos of their other parent abusing them and the GAL has never addressed it."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/al-natalie-jones/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Walter H. Honeycutt

JUDGE · MOBILE · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Ignored evidence of abuse. Ignored a filed protection order while granting my ex husbands emergency orders for pickup and to have my custody stripped based on hersay and false allegations"*

> *"Ignored evidence, victim's testimony, and impeachments (proven multiple times with evidence That the father lied on the stand in the hearing)."*

> *"Only cared that the child was born in Alabama and how much the father made for support"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/al-walter-h-honeycutt/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Public threshold rule: Names are grouped conservatively by normalized spelling, role, and location. Common titles, punctuation, casing, and middle initials collapse together. Close misspellings are not auto-merged without admin review. Only family-direct submissions count toward the public threshold.

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

ALABAMA AT A GLANCE.

Across 158 Alabama families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED
321
155 of 158 families reported child counts

MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN
$52,500
median across 71 families reporting 3+ categories

MEDIAN MONTHS LOST
13
of parenting time

WENT PRO SE
39.9%
63 of 158 who answered; 48 of 158 ran out of money

SUBMISSIONS	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN	COUNTIES REPRESENTED
158	2.1	155 of 158	47

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Alabama families — and families across every represented location — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

03 THE COST OF ALABAMA FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	102	$13,650	$38,619	$3,939,117
Lost Wages	72	$15,000	$130,341	$9,384,571
Other Court Fees	38	$775	$8,120	$308,578
Therapy / Evaluations	56	$2,000	$4,178	$233,976
Reunification Services	30	$300	$1,337	$40,106
GAL Fees	59	$1,200	$4,491	$264,950
Asset Loss [1]	54	$20,000	—	—
Median Family Burden (71 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	$52,500	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least $1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median ($20,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost	13	1.1 yrs
Mean months lost	30	2.5 yrs
Total across all families	3,333	277.8 yrs

04 WHO IS REPORTING · ALABAMA

Most families documenting in Alabama are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children. Percentages below use only families who answered that specific topic.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed	71	46%
Case closed: within last 2 years	29	19%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago	22	14%
Not provided	12	8%
Not in court but still affected	11	7%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS	73	46%
Family Court Only	62	39%
CPS Only	12	8%
Unknown	9	6%
False Allegations / Coached Claims	1	1%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years	56	36%
3 – 5 years	25	16%
5 – 10 years	25	16%
6 months – 1 year	22	14%
Less than 6 months	12	8%

CUSTODY STATUS

Visitation Only	52	33%
No Contact / Total Loss of Access	36	23%
Full Custody	29	18%
50/50 Joint	16	10%
Children in Foster Care	11	7%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Baldwin	31	22%
Autauga	15	11%
Mobile	8	6%
Elmore	6	4%
Cherokee	5	4%
Blount	5	4%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)	46	29%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)	39	25%
Other	23	15%
High Conflict Divorce	21	13%
Medical CPS (Medical Child Abuse allegations, disagreement with doctors)	9	6%

05 PARENT VOICES — ALABAMA

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Alabama comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.

> *Estranged me (the mother) from my kids who were legally kidnapped to the other side of the country in Canada in 2020. Severe CPTSD. My kids all developed depression, insomnia, anxiety and behavioural issues. I have been battling a serious illness (breast cancer) since 2018 with [...]*
>
> — JACKIE

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

My family had been traumatized and my children's innocence shattered. My children loved me and were traumatized by being alienated from me. It shows in every photo or video that we have to say goodbye. They both look sad, confused, angry,and they look like they don't know why I [...]

— ALABAMA PARENT · JOY

MORE VOICES FROM ALABAMA

Judge has placed my two children right back into the hands of our abuser who has many prior convictions, refused all documented evidence, ripped us all out of the protection program and destroyed my family.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The corrupt family court system has permanently damaged my daughters childhoods, created painful memories that will never be forgotten, caused deep agony for my children and myself, and helped abusive people utilize the legal system to “punish” and “retaliate” by keeping me from [...]

— KAREY

This nightmare destroyed my adult life, robbed me of my relationship with my children, joy and the ability to be a productive citizen. All of us have been psychologically tortured and abused. My former honor-student, band leadership, perfect record son is battling mental health [...]

— AMY

Autauga County family court has failed my children and me over and over again. More than 30 years of mental and physchological abuse has been legally perpetuated at the hands of the court system.

— ELIZABETH

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Threatening me with jail time unless I gave into the ex at court. All because I would not give my children to him during my parenting time. Simply because the parenting coordinator and GAL said I should. The judge wants to set an example. You cannot bring your phone on that [...]*
>
> — RACHEL

Caused detrimental emotional and financial hardship, stolen years of our lives and forcing us to Fight for our constitutional rights and Justice.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Stolen my children's childhood Allowed myself and children to live in stalking and abuse Supports domestic violence after divorce and helps abuser continue control . Punishes the abused and supports the abuser . Causes continued cptsd and abuse gives abuser control

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Despite ongoing concerns regarding safety, substance abuse, and repeated criminal proceedings, our family has endured years of delays without final resolution . The cost has been measured in lost time, uncertainty, legal expenses, and stress placed on both me and my children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed our unity our faith and now we all suffer from mental illness. The system is full of liars and abusers.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system did not protect my daughter or my civil rights. We went from myself being her full time caregiver and traumatizingly erased me ,her Mommy, without warning, causing her permanent emotional damage.

— SARA

It took my perfectly whole and happy children and, if I get them back, they will return home broken. My kids no longer trust the world (including me) as they once did.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system fully showed me why the government should have 0 say so or hand in how YOUR CHILD OR CHILDREN ARE parented.

— JESSICA

This court has aided in the psychological abuse and alienation of two children from their life long family support network of grandparents, cousins, and aunts and uncles that they have had no contact with, with no reason stated by parents and absolutely no evidence of harm in [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Destroyed our family my son passed and we have not seen our granddaughter since she didn't even get to come to her dad's funeral*
>
> — KELLI

Family court has destroyed all consistency and stability for my children. We do not feel safe.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

A system ment to bring families together did nothing but traumatically rip mine apart.

— FELICIA

The system has proven to my children and I that they are not there to provide support, protection and reunification. They very boldly stand in your face and laugh while doing the complete opposite due to financial motives. They have stolen the first two years of my children's [...]

— MARY

They falsely accused me of child abuse and took two of my children. Then I had another one and they took her. DHR ended up giving me back the youngest and are making me go to family court against my Dad and stepmom for my other two. I just recently went back to court for the [...]

— LATOYA

Kidnapped my daughter, destroyed my life, and then sent me to prison trying to cover it up

— KRISTI N

They tried to murder me as a service member still under investigation with the military and the judge is even a veteran smh ... Join Achaksah Nation so we can save our own kids because the military won't even do martial law to fix America

— SUBRIA

You will never get back the missed times with your children, never take those small moments for granted. A corrupt system will make you have a whole new outlook on the judicial system. Be strong and never stop fighting NEVER.

— TASHA

William E Scully is deleting documents from the record. Siding with dhr although there is no evidence just false accusations that has never been proven to be true. Terminating my parental rights instead of reunification to families

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *We have been railroaded. I have been falsely accused of being a drug addict. Even though I have passed every single random drug test.*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

For years this situation has ripped my life and the lives of my children apart. It has caused extreme depression for my children, unrelenting trauma, and lost time with myself causing my children to call and cry and beg to come back to be with me. It has caused my children to [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed my relationship with my granddaughter.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have suppressed evidence and said we both were to normal and coparent just fine.

— TODD

I'm on the edge of losing my kids

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has ripped me apart and taken advantage of my children and myself in every conceivable way. Every actor in it is corrupt, they are all in it together and seeking only personal gain and satisfaction rather than justice for the children. It's evil , sick and killing [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Broken and destroyed our family unit and bond As a whole off of lies

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has caused financial hardship and emotional distress.

— JACLYN

The Autauga county legal system has cost our family a sense of security and safety, impacting the peace we have in our own home.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My children send me videos daily crying. They think they don't get to ever come home.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

TORE UP OUR HAPPY HOME AN DESTROYED MY TWINS EMOTIONALLY AND MENTALLY

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *They make you do services and they know your not gonna get your kids back. They take your kids off allegations that was never true and expect you to not to get depressed. Dhr wants to adopt your kids out.*
>
> — KRISTEN

My girls have lost valuable time with me because of false allegations. This man allowed her attorney and her to say things that run through without looking at facts and immediately took her side.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has destroyed my sibling bonds and has caused me and my siblings to live in fear and has taken my little brother and placed him in the hands of an abuser and given or abuser control to know where we are 24 hours a day

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Has caused a lot of stressed,pain to not only me but my children.It also has my children afraid of courts DHR and police departments.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The flawed family court system is an organization of corrupt individuals who take pleasure in dismantling families while profiting from a mother's prolonged suffering. My character has been defamed, my finances have been drained, my life is anchored to a community of toxic [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has ripped my son,his two brothers,myself and more of our members apart. Cause my son alot of distress,anxiety, fear.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They took are kids that had never stayed anywhere and placed them with strangers but are making us fight to have our children. They aren't protecting them they are the ones causing damage!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Stop using our children as money mules !!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

We live in fear and are stalked and harassed daily . Thr court has destroyed my children mentally physically and emotionally and have robbed my children of their childhood .the family court does not protect or care about family

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

98 Alabama parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 44 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — ALABAMA

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Alabama families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

> My family had been traumatized and my children's innocence shattered. My children loved me and were traumatized by being alienated from me. It shows in every photo or video that we have to say goodbye. They both look sad, confused, angry,and they look like they don't know why I want to give them away. During visitation they are laughing, loving, affectionate, binding. Time for goodbye they will hardly look at me. Look sad and confused. Omari was a happy healthy loving attentive lil boy who used to make eye contact and was very verbal. After he went into the system he became mute to the point they thought he was autistic. They said later he was not autistic. And the duster mom sent me a letter and some pictures recently yo tell me both boys are in therapy. And they are both autistic abc Niko my youngest is still banging his head..something he ogvher up between leaving my mom's and going to foster moms. Both sins cal me mana and know who I am and love me. Niko had been banhnn. His head since he was 10 months old ld. He had to weed a bike hellment to visitation every visit. He has never been in my care so sometung he was subject to in the system caused him to act out. He showed siigbs of abuse at visitatin which I documented. No one even looked into it. Can't you talk to me, took photos for wrrote it in a report. In fact the case worker lied and said the oldest son put bruises in Niko in the tub but no 2 years old is strong enough to put bruises like that on a baby's lower back. In the tub no less. My children have suffered unnecessary trauma and abuse to the point of near death from covid because of department negligence, an unethical attorney working fur dhr, a fraudulent
>
> — JOY (1/2)

> psyche doctor contracted by the state. Several case workers resding off fraudulent reports without taking the time to observe and investigate for them selves. A director that wrote fraudulent reports in order to cover het tracks for negligence, perjury, and writing false claims in a report. I hold the entire self accountable for not exhausting all efforts for reunification and violating my constituinal rights to due process and a fair hearing . Withholding resources that would help me, adding classes that won't help me and excluding me at an ISP meeting so I wouldn't be able to speak against them decreasing my visitation. Not being able to make up missed visits and allowing the duster mom to schedule therapy classes and dentist appointments on the one day I get to visit with them several weeks close to the end of my case I was never given the chance to tell my kids goodbye. I know they wonder where I am and they are being gurged to forget about me when I had a very strong bond with both my kids in spite of only seeing them. Approximately 208 days since they were taken into the system omari at 7 months and niko at birth
>
> — JOY (2/2)

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Estranged me (the mother) from my kids who were legally kidnapped to the other side of the country in Canada in 2020. Severe CPTSD. My kids all developed depression, insomnia, anxiety and behavioural issues. I have been battling a serious illness (breast cancer) since 2018 with a second occurrence that happened this past October. Severe poverty, loss, destitution, loss of civil liberties (the government suspended my drivers licence because I couldn't pay outrageous child support- my parents had to drive me to chemotherapy and life-saving medical appointments). My income is long term disability and I get $2150/month. My court order for child support is over $600/month. He won't let it go. I'm in arrears of over $40,000. It's still being tallied up by the month. Any income and credits from GST or other government rebates get garnished and automatically go to him. Severe financial and economic post-separation abuse. Evidence of physical and all other abuse during marriage which I presented to the courts was blatantly ignored & swept under the rug. He remarried and the income between him and his spouse is at least $350,000/year. They tried to bury me alive and still are. Fraud, maliciousness. Contempt of court. Not providing his tax returns for the last 5 years. In the same week I found out I had survived my first occurrence with breast cancer, the ex threatened me with a mobility application to move my kids cross-country. They gave him everything, I lost everything because I was too weak to represent myself and couldn't afford a lawyer. Legal Aid in my province is filled with incompetence and negligence - nobody would help me. In fact, the lawyers from legal aid took

— JACKIE (1/2)

advantage of my vulnerabilities and purposely dragged me, one for an entire year, she did absolutely nothing but gave me false hope. It's really unbelievable and sadistic. I have literally paid with my life and my kids lives because I made the choice to get married. Alberta Canada is festering with some of the most corrupt judges in the Western world. What happened to me and is still happening is absolutely criminal.

— JACKIE (2/2)

Judge has placed my two children right back into the hands of our abuser who has many prior convictions, refused all documented evidence, ripped us all out of the protection program and destroyed my family.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The corrupt family court system has permanently damaged my daughters childhoods, created painful memories that will never be forgotten, caused deep agony for my children and myself, and helped abusive people utilize the legal system to “punish” and “retaliate” by keeping me from my children when they have never gone more than the 5-6 days with their fathers without their mother. I’ve been a constant for them and I’ve been told how much my children have cried for me-the court system allowed this and created this nightmare because they would rather take the easy way out for themselves and their “colleagues” in a situation with layers of conflicting interests, than to become educated on abuse and manipulation tactics so they can appropriately face these situations.

— KAREY

This nightmare destroyed my adult life, robbed me of my relationship with my children, joy and the ability to be a productive citizen. All of us have been psychologically tortured and abused. My former honor-student, band leadership, perfect record son is battling mental health and legal problems and my daughter is emotionally avoidant and has extreme trust issues. Financially, the loss is probably close to 2 million, if you estimate lost wages.

— AMY

Autauga County family court has failed my children and me over and over again. More than 30 years of mental and physchological abuse has been legally perpetuated at the hands of the court system.

— ELIZABETH

Threatening me with jail time unless I gave into the ex at court. All because I would not give my children to him during my parenting time. Simply because the parenting coordinator and GAL said I should. The judge wants to set an example. You cannot bring your phone on that floor of the court house. 10 years of abuse, 4 years of battling in the courts to keep my children and this is where we are. My sons will end up with a vindictive manipulator and the people who enable him.

— RACHEL

Caused detrimental emotional and financial hardship, stolen years of our lives and forcing us to Fight for our constitutional rights and Justice.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Stolen my children's childhood Allowed myself and children to live in stalking and abuse Supports domestic violence after divorce and helps abuser continue control . Punishes the abused and supports the abuser . Causes continued cptsd and abuse gives abuser control

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Despite ongoing concerns regarding safety, substance abuse, and repeated criminal proceedings, our family has endured years of delays without final resolution . The cost has been measured in lost time, uncertainty, legal expenses, and stress placed on both me and my children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed our unity our faith and now we all suffer from mental illness. The system is full of liars and abusers.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system did not protect my daughter or my civil rights. We went from myself being her full time caregiver and traumatizingly erased me ,her Mommy, without warning, causing her permanent emotional damage.

— SARA

It took my perfectly whole and happy children and, if I get them back, they will return home broken. My kids no longer trust the world (including me) as they once did.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system fully showed me why the government should have 0 say so or hand in how YOUR CHILD OR CHILDREN ARE parented.

— JESSICA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This court has aided in the psychological abuse and alienation of two children from their life long family support network of grandparents, cousins, and aunts and uncles that they have had no contact with, with no reason stated by parents and absolutely no evidence of harm in any fashion.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed our family my son passed and we have not seen our granddaughter since she didn't even get to come to her dad's funeral

— KELLI

Family court has destroyed all consistency and stability for my children. We do not feel safe.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

A system ment to bring families together did nothing but traumatically rip mine apart.

— FELICIA

The system has proven to my children and I that they are not there to provide support, protection and reunification. They very boldly stand in your face and laugh while doing the complete opposite due to financial motives. They have stolen the first two years of my children's lives from me.

— MARY

They falsely accused me of child abuse and took two of my children. Then I had another one and they took her. DHR ended up giving me back the youngest and are making me go to family court against my Dad and stepmom for my other two. I just recently went back to court for the other two but they are making me prove something called the McClendon Standard which is only used in Alabama. I wish I could speak on this

— LATOYA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Kidnapped my daughter, destroyed my life, and then sent me to prison trying to cover it up

— KRISTI N

They tried to murder me as a service member still under investigation with the military and the judge is even a veteran smh ... Join Achaksah Nation so we can save our own kids because the military won't even do martial law to fix America

— SUBRIA

You will never get back the missed times with your children, never take those small moments for granted. A corrupt system will make you have a whole new outlook on the judicial system. Be strong and never stop fighting NEVER.

— TASHA

William E Scully is deleting documents from the record. Siding with dhr although there is no evidence just false accusations that has never been proven to be true. Terminating my parental rights instead of reunification to families

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

We have been railroaded. I have been falsely accused of being a drug addict. Even though I have passed every single random drug test.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

For years this situation has ripped my life and the lives of my children apart. It has caused extreme depression for my children, unrelenting trauma, and lost time with myself causing my children to call and cry and beg to come back to be with me. It has caused my children to live in constant fear and trust no one other than myself to save them. I have lost hope for most everything and completely lose my trust in a system designed to protect children and victims.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Destroyed my relationship with my granddaughter.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have suppressed evidence and said we both were to normal and coparent just fine.

— TODD

I'm on the edge of losing my kids

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has ripped me apart and taken advantage of my children and myself in every conceivable way. Every actor in it is corrupt, they are all in it together and seeking only personal gain and satisfaction rather than justice for the children. It's evil , sick and killing our children and community.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Broken and destroyed our family unit and bond As a whole off of lies

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It has caused financial hardship and emotional distress.

— JACLYN

The Autauga county legal system has cost our family a sense of security and safety, impacting the peace we have in our own home.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My children send me videos daily crying. They think they don't get to ever come home.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

TORE UP OUR HAPPY HOME AN DESTROYED MY TWINS EMOTIONALLY AND MENTALLY

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They make you do services and they know your not gonna get your kids back. They take your kids off allegations that was never true and expect you to not to get depressed. Dhr wants to adopt your kids out.

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Has caused a lot of stressed,pain to not only me but my children.It also has my children afraid of courts DHR and police departments.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The flawed family court system is an organization of corrupt individuals who take pleasure in dismantling families while profiting from a mother's prolonged suffering. My character has been defamed, my finances have been drained, my life is anchored to a community of toxic individuals who have sided with my abuser. My children have been alienated from me, groomed, neglected, and harmed as a result of the family court's negligence!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It has ripped my son,his two brothers,myself and more of our members apart. Cause my son alot of distress,anxiety, fear.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They took are kids that had never stayed anywhere and placed them with strangers but are making us fight to have our children. They aren't protecting them they are the ones causing damage!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Stop using our children as money mules !!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

We live in fear and are stalked and harassed daily . Thr court has destroyed my children mentally physically and emotionally and have robbed my children of their childhood .the family court does not protect or care about family

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have stolen years that we will never get back.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My soul was ripped from me. I tried to do right by the law and help my son, I was told I was crazy, I had problems and that I was overprotective of my son. It's been 2yrs, No contact.. I am an auto repeat living, because I'm not really living, I'm numb.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They left my kids in abusive situation drugging them. Medicaid paid for seroquel 300 for 9 yr old. Suicide attempts. My kids are adults

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

We lost our grandson at 15 months, who we had raised since birth. Our granddaughter was born addicted and taken into state custody at birth. We were ready and able to take them both. Falsified drug tests on the DCS service provider. I paid for a hair follicle test and proved them erroneous. I am currently in a federal case against these state actors Tate and Davis for denying my rights to visit and gain custody. The judge was recused and changed. Our new judge took 10 days to return the children to our sole custody

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Jefferson County GAL was corrupt and dismissed drug usage of parent given primary custody. She also falsified previous agreement signed by court child support was waived and I am now paying child support with arrears. Jefferson co family court is infiltrated with corrupt bias GAL'S.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They took tragedy as an opportunity to create lasting trauma my family and I still have not fully recovered from. We haven't even had a ceremony to grieve our lost son yet because we're still trying to recover from the disaster that destroyed everything.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My children have been alienated from me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They physically mentally and emotionally abused me and my child and financially took everything from me by my mental stage I have not been able to work since I cannot focus on that when I was focusing trying to figure out why there's taking my child in the first place

— JODIE

They've taken children who already lost their parents and put them in dangerous situations when they have a loving grandmother who would give her life to protect and love them.

— STEPHANIE

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Left me isolated from every one and mentally debilitated me with phyco report says 60% out of a 100 is my custody n dcp issue

— CLOEY

They have ruined my life, making my daughter feel unsafe because we can't be together.

— MEGAN

ASTNGU. AMTNGU. This bond between us can’t be broken, I will be here don’t you cry. You’ll be in my Heart. Always.

— HEATHER

CPS and family court trafficked my children to the pedophile father and erased me, a safe, protective mother from my daughter's lives. I have a gag order and am not allowed to speak about my case. But I still do however I can.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I will never forget the look of devastation and tears running down on my children’s face when I walked out of the courtroom fighting back my own tears and had to tell them they were not able to go home with me that day.

— LAUREN

Gave away guard ship kinship without a hearing, suppressed evidence, denied motions out being heard, denied justification transfer, threatened me, tried to silence me, neglecting care for two disabled for two years

— ASHLEE

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The court allowed my sister-in-law to walk in there and say I was messed up on drugs leaving my two year old defend for herself. I never got served properly. My neighbor found it in her mailbox, but I still had to hand my children over only two of them, though I got to keep the other two. Until July of 24 and my oldest son got taken because I was stupid and didn't get a lawyer at all. My 13-year-old has never been taken she with me the whole time.. they allowed my sister-in-law to play games with my children when she couldn't handle it she gave them back to me. I got to keep them for a month and then we went back to court. They made me have my kids back over again because they didn't do a drug test on me. Then when I did my drug test the past they still wouldn't give me my kids.

— CRYSANY

Took the life of my husband, almost mine and alienated maternal side of the family, unjust actions to terminate my rights. They have taken both of my daughters parents from her.

— HEIDI

Not allowing for me make contact with my daughter, enabling my ex's bad behavior, by allowing her to hide my daughter from me, not telling if she's okay or not, just dead silence

— TERRY

The system has broke my family down to the point that it is past the point of being repaired. They have destroyed everything we've worked for and I will never get that back.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Made me a visitor in my son's life. Kept my son from having a meaningful relationship with his dad. Kept a wedge between me and my son's mother.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

One woman was allowed to change the trajectory of my whole family

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It has cost me a lot of money and a lot of loss. It caused me 2 wrecks and health issues

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My son was robbed for his right to be raised by his mother. They gave my child to a pedophile's mother!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It completely destroyed my well being mentally and physically it made me physically sick from what they would allow and wouldn't allow i spent so much money and time for a full year

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I have lost precious time with my kids, had them alienated from mom and GAL, lost money trying to fight a system that is a losing battle, depression, and made to look like someone that doesn't care about their kids or take care of them when I worked and made sure they were taken care of their entire life.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I am broken as a result. I will never be a whole person again

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Tore my family apart. I haven't talked to my son in months

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Almost made us homeless. Horned our mental and physical health. Drained our finances. Caused us to live in fear. Taken my child's future funds.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> Fighting the system over false allegations for over two years has cost my family lost time, over $160,000, mental health, and family relationships, leaving us with nothing but a broken family.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Has kept my family apart for 11 months this
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Made us fight lies and evil with no way to prove innocence.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> I want people to know that just because you have a past doesn't mean you should lose your kids when your a good mother and as a mom and for the child they lose all that time all those special moments growing it confuses the kids I feel like I lost my mother hood and will never be the same I love my kids more then anything I lost more then words can describe. It really ruins your life in ways that are horrible to know someone can just up and tell the court something and then they just give your rights a way and gives custody to some one else with no proof
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Allowed an abusive person to have custody of a vulnerable child and use the courts to continue to abuse me. My child has now been exposed to abuse and been the victim of abuse.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Separated me from my kids
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

They have dragged this out and kept me in a wreck over all the lies. I moved 23 miles away from our marital home the father objected to the move and the judge agreed. We were allowed to move but I had to drive 35 to 45 minutes two times a day for a year and a half for my children for school because I was not allowed to change their school.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Caused PTSD and constant fear.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has absolutely tore my family apart. I now deal with trauma and will need counseling and I have my baby back but I feel I have to put cameras in every room in my home because of what I've been through with these allegations .

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

If you wanted to destroy a powerful woman... you wouldn't go after her directly. You'd go after her heart. Her children. Her sanity. This is family court and it's destroying the heart and soul of our children

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Thankfully my family court battle started when my daughter was a baby and her last visit with her father was 2019. But the fear of the Judge and how everything went down was enough to last a lifetime. I hate anyone going through family court. It's so unfair.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My son suffers from always worrying about DHR coming to get him. They have tried for 14 years to take my son. I told them they wasn't getting mine and that it was harassment after so many visits. I told them it wasn't a crime to be poor as long as my child had his needs met.

— TRACY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Ruined our lives, my reputation, loss my kids over lies, cause depression, lost my job then my home, caused so much pain for my kids my 3 youngest they just lost their dad a few months before they were taken away, manipulated me to move from Florida to Alabama saying they were going to give me resources etc... it's so much I can say about this cruel cold hearted system BALDWIN COUNTY DHR is not for helping families they are destroying us & give single mothers no chance or hope to move forward I'm all my kids had n now they don't have that please I'm in desperate need of help

— LAQUILA

The family court process has left me emotionally exhausted, deeply overwhelmed, and constantly fighting to protect both my peace and my relationship with my daughter. What was meant to provide stability instead became a source of chronic stress, heartbreak, and emotional erosion.

— BAILEY

This system has completely removed a mother from her children and created a divide amongst the entire family due to their inability to hear relevant evidence, witness testimonies and consider documented facts on the case, leaving me homeless, unemployed and permanently disabled for the rest of my life.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Tried to make me kill myself

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Carol Cook Carter and Joy Booth both put my child's life in danger. They both looked at evidence showing where my child's father was abusive to me during our relationship and also where he had threatened both my life and my child's, and they still sided for him to receive joint custody of our child.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It cost me everything.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It's cost me my world. All I ever wanted was to be a mother and now I'm in the fight of my life praying to reach the light at the end and be able to hold my daughter again.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has showed us that no matter how good a person you are, or how right you are, there are people in positions of power who will gleefully make you the scum of the earth in the eyes of the court. It doesn't matter how insane another person is or how many crazy things they do, if the court is on their side then they're gonna win.

— JASON

I am terrified to let my child out of my site. Every single little mark I am documenting it all. I cptsd and am having to go to therapy for this. I have nightmares of this even after 3 yrs. I have a hard time letting anyone visit us.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Some days I sit back and realize... the worst thing that has ever happened in my life barely exists in anyone else's. My child was taken away. My world stopped. My heart broke in a way that will never fully heal. But the world didn't stop. People kept laughing. Kept posting. Kept living like nothing happened. And I don't blame them... but it still hurts. Because for me, it's not a "moment." It's not something I can move past. It's not a memory I can just visit when I feel like it. It's my everyday life. It's waking up missing them. Going to sleep missing them. Hearing their name in my head but not out loud. Living in a world that keeps moving... without them. And sometimes it feels like I'm the only one still standing in the middle of the loss, while everybody else already walked away from it. Like my pain is too big for people to sit with, so they just... don't. But I carry it. Every single day. I carry the love. I carry the memories. I carry the "what ifs." I carry the silence. So if I seem distant, or different, or heavy sometimes... just know— I'm living a life I never asked for, without someone I can never replace. And even if the world moved on... I never will.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ruined everything I made.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

How can any person decide alone who is allowed to be a mother regardless. My momma told me at 17, pregnant, " you don't get to choose when you're ready to be a mother." That I'll never forget. This is a bond that cannot be broken. Why bash fathers or mother who WANT to be there. Why not bash the ones who DONT FIGHT.

— HEATHER

My daughter and I cannot move forward with our lives. We cannot relocate to live with my soon to be husband. I cannot give her a two parent home with financial stability and a support system. I'm being kept here on my own as a single mother, struggling to maintain housing, work, and a vehicle because of financial strain. I don't know how I'm going to keep my current job and get her picked up after school.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I spent years trying to protect my family, only to watch prolonged litigation drain our finances, destroy our stability, and leave us homeless. My daughter has special needs, and the system that should have helped us instead made it harder to keep her safe, housed, and connected to the services she needs.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

98 full approved Alabama comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a public, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Alabama report comes from Alabama respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Alabama — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 158 Alabama families reporting here are not the universe of Alabama families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. Response counts and percentages use the number of families who answered that specific topic or financial field. The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – November 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

Dollar fields exclude blank, negative, and obvious data-entry artifact values above the report's field caps. When asset-loss values contain a strong statistical outlier, the asset-loss mean and total are suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county or regional field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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